CYBERCRIME-UPI/ONLINE PAYMENT FRAUD

Case Study: UPI Fraud Through Fake Customer Support

1.Background:Aman, a small business owner, wanted help regarding a failed online payment. He searched for customer care support of his UPI app on the internet .

2.Incident: He found a phone number listed on a website. Believing it to be genuine, he called the number. The person on the call claimed to be a customer support executive and asked Aman to install a screen-sharing app to “resolve the issue quickly.” Trusting him, Aman followed the instructions. The fraudster then guided him to open his UPI application and enter his PIN under the pretext of verification.

3.Outcome:Within minutes, multiple unauthorized transactions were made from Aman’s bank account, totaling ₹60,000. The fraudster had gained access through screen sharing and used Aman’s UPI credentials to transfer money.

4.Action Taken:Realizing the fraud, Aman immediately contacted his bank and reported the incident on the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in). Although the bank managed to block further transactions, most of the money was already lost.

5.Conclusion:This incident highlights how scammers exploit trust and urgency. Users should never share their UPI PIN, OTP, or allow screen access to unknown individuals. Official customer care numbers should always be verified from trusted sources. Awareness and caution are essential to prevent such online payment frauds.